

Figure 1: Keryx welcome screen



Figure 3: Main interface

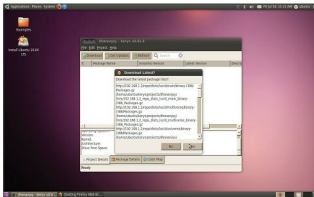


Figure 2: Package list download

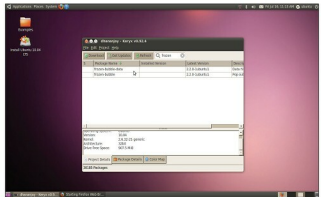


Figure 4: Searching for the Frozen-Bubble package

or have one that's slow and unreliable. It aims to provide a streamlined approach towards package management for offline systems.

Keryx is a very young project, and currently only supports distros that use the apt (Debian) package management system. Support for other systems is currently being worked on. Keryx makes the management of updates and installations unbelievably easy. It is highly portable, and you can use a Linux, Windows or even a Mac system to download your packages. With Keryx, it only takes a couple of clicks for your program to be installed.

Using Keryx

Let's assume the simplest scenario: we will work on two systems, one of which is our offline system (which we will call the base system), and an online system that is used to download the packages (which we will refer to as the host system). I am using Keryx-0.92-2 on Ubuntu 10.04 as my base system.

Keryx works on the principle of projects: we create a project on our base system, which stores information about the base system. We carry the USB drive (with Keryx and the project on it) to the host system, and use Keryx to download our packages. Keryx will solve dependency issues itself. Then we carry back the USB drive with the downloaded packages, and install them on the base system.

Here's a step-by-step procedure that makes using Keryx simple:

1. Getting Keryx: On the online system, grab a copy of keryx.zip from www.keryxproject.org/download, and unzip it to a USB flash drive (or any writeable portable medium). Eject the USB drive before you unplug it, to ensure that most recent changes are flushed to the drive.
2. Creating a project: Plug in the USB drive to the base system, mount it, and open up a terminal window. Assuming the flash disk is mounted at `/media/usbstick`, issue the following command:

```
$ cd /media/usbstick/keryx/linux
```

Make the 'keryx' file executable by issuing the command given below:

```
$ chmod +x keryx
```

Start Keryx by clicking (or double-clicking, as necessary) the Keryx icon in the folder `keryx/linux/`. Alternately, in the terminal in which you ran the preceding commands, run the command `/keryx`. Keryx' home screen gets loaded (see Figure 1), and it asks you to create a new project, or open an existing project. Give the project a name (I chose 'ubuntu'), and select the plug-in `debian`,